exporter of services at $828 billion in 2018. It had a positive trade balance in services of $269 billion. Three European countries, the UK, Germany and France, occupied the next three positions with exports of $376 billion, $331 billion and $291 billion, respectively.

With a share of 3.51 per cent in global exports in services, India exported $205 billion of services in the three modes. The country imported $177 billion worth of services, which gave us a surplus of $28 billion on the services trade.

The World Trade Report 2019—The Future of Services Trade of the WTO takes a wider view by including services delivered through subsidiaries/branches of companies in other countries. According to this report, trade in services grew at a faster rate than the trade in goods between 2005 and 2017, at 5.4 per cent, and was worth $13.3 trillion. Commercial presence in the form of subsidiaries and branches was the most dominant mode accounting for about 59 per cent of export of services, with cross-border services amounting to about 28 per cent, consumption abroad about 10 per cent, and the balance 3 per cent in the form of presence of individuals in another country.

Like the UNCTAD data, even in terms of the wider definition adopted in this report, the share of developing countries was smaller at 25 per cent of global exports and 35 per cent of global import of services. The least developing countries had a minuscule share of 0.3 per cent of global exports and 0.9 per cent of global imports. The report expects the share of services trade to rise to 50 per cent of total global trade by 2040.